Newsletter on Commercial Applications of AI

THE SIGNAL LAYER

Your monthly report on commercial AI, rephrased for the rest of us

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AI Stopped Asking for Permission this Month

Three weeks. Three sectors. Three products of AI have gone through all creative processes from a simple AI design to a full agency with its own activities in fields of health care, finance, and law. In healthcare, OpenAI created a health tab for a person's laboratory tests. In finance, a new enterprise has developed an AI employee that takes care of all unpaid invoices automatically. In law, it was the only one called legal personnel and allowed to do real jobs, not only create documents. If you have doubts about whether AI is a myth or a reality nowadays, you will get the answer in this issue.

Summary of What We Covered This Month

In this issue, we cover product launches and announcements from the past weeks in three sectors where AI is changing the way decisions are made: Healthcare (AI for patient interaction), Finance (AI for back-office work), and Legal services (which includes contract and compliance work). What is changing is not just "better chat" but the trust in AI to carry out the tasks of the job being more extensive, with the job involving direct human supervision instead of humans being together with machine.

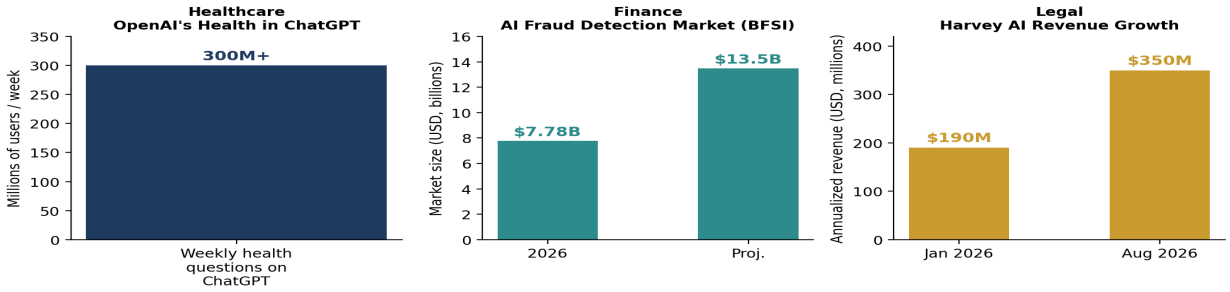


Figure 1. How these three industries managed to adopt AI and gain revenue.

1. Healthcare: Your Chatbot Knows About Your Lab Results

On July 23, 2026, OpenAI launched "Health in ChatGPT," which became available to every U.S. citizens who are older than 18 years old. This service enables users to securely connect their Apple Health account and, when available, their patient records from hospital, One Medical, and Function Health systems with ChatGPT. Instead of just attaching a lab report and praying for the best outcome, users can ask any question based on their medicines, tests, visit record, sleep record, and physical activities.

The relevance for decision-making

Every week, over 300 million people are asking ChatGPT health-related questions. This shows how much informal health decision-making is happening. OpenAI is attempting to bring some order by the information from the real medical records and not general internet information. OpenAI claims that more than 260 physicians were involved in building the new feature, which will help patients get ready for a doctor's appointment and understand the results of medical tests, but should not replace a physician's diagnosis.

The catch

The launch took place a day after a lawsuit claimed that OpenAI is providing unsafe medical advice and demanded that the rollout be halted until an independent safety review is conducted. OpenAI maintains that ChatGPT was "not intended for the diagnosis or treatment of any health condition" and mentions

encryption, 30-day period for data deletion, and refusal to use health data for ad placement or model building purposes.

2. Finance: Introducing AI that Performs the Task at Hand

In July 2023, Payouts.com launched “Digital Employee”, a series of AI programs allowing for the completion of various finance tasks and processes. According to Payouts.com, the AI “reads invoices, matches them, processes them, and asks for help from human supervisors whenever necessary”. Of course, this differs greatly from the previous financial bots, which only provided humans with reports to act on.

The relevance for decision-making

Conventional automated systems operate based on rules but fail when the data does not match perfectly: invoices that do not correspond to the purchase orders, charge disputes, judgment calls in terms of month-end closing. The “Digital Employee” was created to work within strict cost limits, and for at least two weeks, new agents receive guidance in their actions before being able to function independently.

The bigger trend

It’s evident that this is not a one-off incident. July saw more notable launches in the fintech sector, including the introduction of Klaviyo's AI marketing, Composer, as well as different AI fraud detection and underwriting products such as Cowbell Insurance’s, OMNI. The global market for the AI market in fraud detection and prevention within banking, financial services and insurance is forecasted to grow from approximately $7.78 billion to weigh more than $13 billion soon, meaning that the leaders of the finance sector are relying heavily on AI to solve issues that humans would be unable to discover besides expediting paperwork.

3. Legal: AI Agents have finally gained their certification

On August 4th, 2026, the legal AI corporation called Harvey disclosed its achievement of AIUC-1 certification, which is as a matter of fact the very first certification ever introduced for AI agents involved in legal activities. Shortly after that, it became known that the company is now in the process of gathering $500 million of funding at its current worth of $15.5 billion, a significant rise from $11 billion recorded five months ago, while its revenue amounts to over $350 million now compared to $190 million last January.

Why it matters for decision-making

Law firms currently use Harvey's service "Agents" which allows users to carry out the complete multi-phase legal process, which includes comparing contracts with the firm's internal protocols, identifying non-standard provisions, and writing suggestions for revising the contract. The company claims to have more than 1900 legal clients steered by Harvey, and that the service is used by over 200 public organizations. Hence, it is essential to validate the technology, since using it generates legal risks for the law firm and requires the attorneys to be sure of the quality of the final output of the AI before the real contract is signed.

Increased Competition

Harvey is not the only service in the domain. Microsoft launched its "Legal Agent" for Word in April 2026 (partly developed by a team that joined from Robin AI). The same applies to other platforms which also keep building more automated parts of their services. In general, the trend this year shows that legal AI is becoming more advanced and less reliant on direct supervision of attorneys.

Spotlight Analysis: Certification of Harvey's AIUC-1

Among the three stories of the month, Harvey's certification is worthy of great attention. The reason for this is not that the certification came as the most attention-grabbing achievement but because it highlights the fact that the AI adoption fails in different sectors no matter where we look.

• **Immediate effects**: Having received certification makes it easier for the risk-averse users in the AI market such as general counsels, compliance officers, insurers to refer to a third-party strong proof of trust when they agree to the use of AI agents for decision-making in law.

• **Efficiency**: The certification becomes a pioneer example for other AI service providers and regulators to catch up with, so as SOC 2 standard became a norm for the IT sector.

• **Prospects for the future**: If the certification practices spread into healthcare and finance industry, it is quite possible that this innovation will become the first opportunity for AI agents to undertake more responsibility in making important decisions.

This month across the three sectors, all the product which got some traction are not the most impactful products with the best demos rather they are the ones which are combined with the autonomy of the product with adequate guardrails including shadow mode, human sign off threshold, third-party certification and physician-reviewed rubric i.e. the pairing of the two structures is more responsible of determining which of the machine learning products are able to perform real tasks in the year 2026.

The Conclusion

As the healthcare, financial and legal services industries are among the most regulated, and the riskiest sectors in which a company can operate, the news release about these developments matters a lot this month. When AI is provided with some authority over patient sensitive information, payments by companies or legal documents, it means that the technology has stepped out of the experimental phase. The leading companies in creating such products don’t construct the most brilliant AI models, but they seem to build the most reliable systems of governance.

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AI Usage Disclosure

I have implemented Claude (Anthropic) for researching and brainstorming ideas and formatting the references in APA format.